

Straw hat with ribbon and ostrich feather trimming

Fans still popular and very large

Lace decoration

1902

Narrow skirt ends in short train

Promenade dress Although the V-shaped ruffle of the bodice mimics the low décolletage of evening dresses, this delicate creation covers the entire body. It was made by the House of Drécoll, which was opened in Paris in 1905.

Ruffles give the illusion of elbow-length sleeves

Straw hat worn at jaunty angle

Fabric insert for fake décolletage

S-bend

1905

Parasols helped to conserve fashionable pale complexion

French daydress This confection accentuates the fashionable S-bend posture and emphasizes the narrow waist and "mono-bosom". While the skirt is relatively plain, the bodice remains elaborately decorated.

Soft hat with plumage

Deep turned-back cuffs

Long gloves stretch to elbow-length sleeves

Jacket hemmed to hip length

1913

Slim-fitting skirt

Shoes or boots with Louis heel

Sash made of same fabric as blouse

Hat with feather

High lace collar

Skirt loose around hips

Narrow knee area

Flowered silk

Shoe buckles reminiscent of 18th century

Pour le Matin This tailored French morning suit for spring 1913 features a prominent high waistband and asymmetric button fastening. The skirt takes the newly fashionable slim column shape, narrowing to the ankles.

New silhouette This ensemble was recommended for holiday travelling wear. The skirt is relatively loose but narrows towards the hem where it allows a glimpse of the wearer's shoes and stockings – a new focus for decoration.

HATS AND SHOES

While some women favoured small, modest hats, others wore huge creations decorated with ribbons, flowers, and feathers. Hats floated on elaborate coiffures created with the aid of transformations (hair pieces). With these lavish trimmings, occasionally incorporating entire birds, large hats had to be kept in place with long and often highly decorated hat pins.

Hat ribbon echoes bow at neck



Straw hat



Ostrich feather trim

Hat with feather

For daywear, women could choose between practical and sturdy laced or buttoned ankle boots and shoes. Heels returned to a manageable height and were usually of the curved "Louis" heel type. Straight-sided, stacked leather "Cuban" heels became popular towards the end of the first decade.



Ankle boot with Louis heel

Buttoned ankle boot



Laced shoe